

Word family: **strange / stranger / strangest / strangely / strangeness**

Base word: strange

Comparative: stranger

Superlative: strangest

Related forms: strangely, strangeness

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / related adverb and noun forms (相關副詞及名詞)

Your sentence:

> “In a **strange** way, watching it made me slow down mentally as well.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **strange** means **unusual or unexpected in a way that is hard to explain**.

The speaker means it felt a little surprising that simply watching the sea turtle could make his own mind slow down and become calmer.

繁體中文： **有點不尋常、出乎意料，甚至難以解釋的**

中文翻譯：

> “In a **strange** way, watching it made me slow down mentally as well.”

「以一種有點**奇怪 / 意想不到**的方式，看着牠也讓我的思緒慢了下來。」

Here:

in a strange way = 以一種有點難以解釋、出乎意料的方式

1. **strange = unusual / unfamiliar (不尋常) — 奇怪的；異常的；不尋常的**

This is the central meaning and the one used in your passage.

Meaning: Unusual, unexpected, or different from what is normal or familiar.

Practice 1 — Original

> “In a **strange** way, watching it made me slow down mentally.”

「以一種有點**奇怪 / 意想不到**的方式，看着牠讓我的思緒慢了下來。」

Practice 2

> “I heard a **strange** noise outside.”

「我聽到外面有一陣**奇怪的**聲音。」

Practice 3

> “There was something **strange** about his behaviour.”

「他的行為有些地方很**不尋常 / 奇怪**。」

strange = 與平常、預期或熟悉情況不同，因此令人覺得奇怪或難以解釋的

Common:

- * strange noise
- * strange feeling
- * strange behaviour
- * strange situation
- * strange way

2. **strange** = unfamiliar / not known to you (陌生) — 陌生的；不熟悉的

Strange can specifically mean unfamiliar.

Practice 4

> “Everything felt **strange** in the new city.”

「在新城市裡，一切都感到很**陌生**。」

Practice 5

> “The room looked **strange** without the old furniture.”

「沒有了舊家具，那個房間看起來很**陌生 / 不一樣**。」

strange = 因為不熟悉、未曾接觸或與原本習慣不同而令人感到陌生

This is closely related to Meaning 1, but the emphasis is:

> **not familiar**

rather than merely:

> **odd or unusual**

For strict counting, I would usually merge both under one broad **unusual/unfamiliar** sense.

3. **strange** = odd / difficult to explain (怪異) — 古怪的 ; 離奇的

Strange can have a stronger sense of being puzzling or hard to explain.

Practice 6

> “A **strange** light appeared in the sky.”

「天空出現了一道**離奇 / 奇怪的**光。」

Practice 7

> “It was a very **strange** coincidence.”

「那是一個非常**離奇的**巧合。」

strange = 不只不尋常，而且令人困惑、難以解釋或覺得有點怪異

This is a nuance of Meaning 1 rather than a separate core sense.

4. **strange** = feeling physically/emotionally unusual (感覺) — 怪怪的 ; 不對勁的

A person can **feel strange** when they feel physically or emotionally different from normal.

Practice 8

> “I felt **strange** after standing up too quickly.”

「我站得太快之後感覺有點**怪怪的 / 不舒服**。」

Practice 9

> “She felt **strange** returning to her old school.”

「回到舊學校時，她感覺有點**異樣 / 怪怪的**。」

feel strange = 身體或情緒上出現和平常不同、難以準確描述的感覺

This is still the broad **unusual/not normal** concept.

5. **strange** = socially unfamiliar / unknown person (與陌生人概念相關) — 陌生的

In combinations such as:

> strange people

> strange faces

strange can mean unknown or unfamiliar rather than odd.

Practice 10

> “She was surrounded by **strange** faces.”

「她四周都是**陌生的**面孔。」

Practice 11

> “The child was nervous around **strange** adults.”

「那個孩子在**陌生的**成年人身邊會感到緊張。」

This is useful because Chinese learners may otherwise translate **strange** only as 「奇怪」.

Here:

strange = 不認識的 / 陌生的

For core counting, I would merge it with Meaning 2.

Related form: **strangely**

Strangely has two common uses.

strangely = in an unusual way (奇怪地)

Practice 12

> “He was behaving **strangely**.”

「他的行為很**奇怪**。」

strangely = surprisingly (出乎意料地)

Practice 13

> “**Strangely**, I felt calmer after the conversation.”

「**很奇怪 / 出乎意料地**，談完之後我反而更冷靜。」

strangely = 以不尋常、難以解釋或出乎意料的方式

This is especially close to your original:

> **in a strange way**

Related form: **strangeness**

Strangeness means the quality of being strange.

Practice 14

> “The **strangeness** of the situation made everyone uncomfortable.”

「情況的**奇怪 / 異常之處**令大家感到不自在。」

Practice 15

> “She gradually became used to the **strangeness** of the new environment.”

「她漸漸習慣了新環境的**陌生感**。」

strangeness = 奇怪、不尋常或陌生的性質 / 感覺

Important distinction: **strange vs weird**

strange

is fairly neutral and broad:

* unusual

* unfamiliar

* puzzling

weird

is more informal and often stronger:

* very odd

* bizarre

* unsettling

> "That's strange."

neutral.

> "That's weird."

more colloquial and often stronger.

Important distinction: **strange vs unusual**

unusual

simply means not common or not normal.

strange

often adds a feeling of:

* puzzlement

* unfamiliarity

* oddness

> unusual weather

may simply mean uncommon weather.

> strange weather

may suggest it feels odd or difficult to explain.

Important distinction: **strange vs unfamiliar**

unfamiliar

specifically means not known or recognized.

strange

can mean unfamiliar, but also odd or unusual.

> unfamiliar place

= 不熟悉的地方

> strange place

could mean:

* 陌生的地方

* 奇怪的地方

Context decides.

Important distinction: **strange vs odd**

odd

often means unusual or peculiar and can be slightly more conversational.

strange

is broader and can also mean unfamiliar.

> odd behaviour

> strange behaviour

Both are natural.

But:

> strange faces

can simply mean unfamiliar faces, whereas **odd faces** means unusual-looking faces.

Important distinction: **strange vs foreign**

foreign

means from another country or culture.

strange

means unfamiliar or unusual.

A place can feel strange without being foreign.

So:

strange ≠ foreign

Important distinction: **strange vs stranger**

Despite the similar spelling:

strange

= adjective

> a strange person

> 奇怪 / 陌生的人

stranger

= noun meaning someone you do not know

> “Don’t talk to strangers.”

「不要跟**陌生人**說話。」

Stranger is historically related, but in modern English it is a distinct lexical item rather than simply the comparative of **strange** in all uses.

Important complication:

> stranger

can also be the comparative:

> “This is stranger than I expected.”

= 「這比我預期的更奇怪。」

So **stranger** has two grammatical identities:

* comparative adjective of strange

* noun = 陌生人

This is worth flagging for learners.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **strange**

* **stranger**

* **strangest**

* **strangely**

* **strangeness**

Special caution:

stranger can be either:

* comparative adjective: 更奇怪的

* independent noun: 陌生人

That ambiguity makes it especially useful in a family sweep.

The Golden Manual says the family sweep should include derivational forms and lexical relatives while accurately labelling when a related-looking form has developed its own lexical meaning.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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strange — unusual/odd	與平常、預期或正常情況不同，令人覺得奇怪或難以解釋的
strange — unfamiliar	因未曾接觸、不認識或不熟悉而令人感到陌生的
feel strange	身體或情緒出現與平常不同、難以準確描述的異樣感
strangely	以不尋常、難以解釋或出乎意料的方式
strangeness	奇怪、不尋常或陌生的性質 / 感覺
stranger — comparative	更奇怪的
stranger — noun	自己不認識的人；陌生人

For your original sentence

> “In a **strange** way, watching it made me slow down mentally as well.”

The exact meaning is:

strange = 有點不尋常、出乎意料，而且難以完全解釋

So:

> **in a strange way**

= **以一種有點奇妙 / 意想不到的方式**

The speaker does **not** mean the turtle itself was weird. The surprising thing is the effect that watching it had on his own mental state.

For your database, I would count **2** genuinely useful core meanings for **strange**:

1. **unusual, odd, or difficult to explain**
2. **unfamiliar / not known or recognized**

I would merge **feel strange** and stronger puzzling uses under #1, keep unfamiliar people/places under #2, and explicitly flag **stranger** because it functions both as the comparative of **strange** and as the independent noun **“a person you do not know.”**